



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Highlands Latin School of Louisville
School Website: <https://hls.org/>

December 27, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Highlands Latin School Louisville KY 40243 presents a strong, explicit alignment with classical education as defined by the classical-school rubric. Public-facing materials repeatedly emphasize classical content, Christian formation, and traditional pedagogical approaches (e.g., grammar, logic, rhetoric; Latin as core; memorization and recitation; early exposure to Latin and Greek; and engagement with Western literary/cultural tradition). The school presents itself as a classical, Christian, and traditional institution with a clear mission to form character and wisdom in partnership with parents, guided by the Gospel. The aggregate assessment across the six categories places Highlands Latin Squarely in CLASSICAL territory, with robust signals in Curriculum, Pedagogy, Faculty, and Parents/Community, and clear religious/metaphysical foundations supporting the overall classical orientation.

Key evidence themes include: - Public materials frame the school as "classical, Christian, traditional" and emphasize the classical tradition as the aim of education, not merely information transfer.

- The curriculum centers Latin (and Greek), with a grammar-logic-rhetoric (trivium) progression, and explicit statements that Latin is core to a classical education.
- Pedagogy emphasizes memorization, recitation, and the cultivation of memory in the grammar years, with traditional classrooms, and a music program that anchors within Western/traditional sacred art.
- The school foregrounds partnership with parents and a Gospel-guided mission, indicating a strong community/parental formation emphasis.
- There are explicit references to "the classics," "reading the classics to develop wisdom and virtue," and commitments to virtue formation and faith formation as part of the educational telos.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL
- Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL
- Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL
- Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL
- Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL
- Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Overall, Highlands Latin School Louisville KY 40243 is CLASSICAL.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school identifies itself publicly as a classical, Christian school and positions Christian character as a central aspect of its mission. - The mission statement explicitly ties education to Gospel-guided formation and the love of Our Lord, framing the school as a Christian institution within the classical tradition. - Exhortations and opening messages describe partnership with parents, the Gospel, and living faith as foundational to the school's approach. - Founding leadership and rhetoric from Cheryl Lowe foreground Christian

moral formation within a classical framework. - The school's music program and liturgical/church-anchored elements (e.g., prayers/hymns in openings) point to liturgical/community practices integral to education.

Positive keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Christian, Gospel, virtue, wisdom, wisdom/virtue formation, faith, God, sacred tradition, theology, liturgy, reverence, wonder (as implied by the language around forming affections toward truth/good/beauty and a living faith). Evidence sources explicitly include Christian identity and Gospel-guided formation. (Examples cited above.) - Negative keyword indicators: Not evident in the sources provided. The lexicon's negative signals (e.g., secularism, relativism) do not appear as explicit claims about Highlands Latin. The available sources emphasize religious/metaphysical grounding rather than its absence.

Why this rating - The presence of explicit Christian framing, gospel-centered formation, liturgical/community practices, and a stated aim to form virtue and wisdom through a Christian classical lens supports CLASSICAL in this category.

Cited evidence - Highlands Latin as classical, Christian, traditional: turn0file0. - Mission: Gospel-guided classical formation: turn0file1. - Exhortation language (opening school; prayer/hymn; foundation languages; living faith): turn0file13.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school explicitly frames its goal as forming knowledge, wisdom, and character within the classical tradition, not as purely vocational outcomes. The mission emphasizes "the highest standards of the classical tradition" and "grow in knowledge, wisdom, and the love of Our Lord." - Descriptions highlight formation and virtue as the telos of education, with phrases like "classical education of the highest quality" and "to the highest standards of the classical tradition, so that they may grow in knowledge, wisdom, and the love of Our Lord." - Language linking truth/virtue/wisdom to education appears throughout (e.g., "reading the classics to develop wisdom and virtue" and the emphasis on virtue formation and character).

Positive keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, truth, goodness, beauty (as conceptual anchors; "wisdom," "virtue," "classical tradition," "formation," "great conversation" are implied in the materials provided; the explicit phrases include "highest standards of the classical tradition," "grow in knowledge, wisdom, and the love of Our Lord," and "reading the classics to develop wisdom and virtue.") - Negative keyword indicators: None explicitly evident in the public materials. The emphasis remains on formation and transcendent aims rather than workforce/productivity language.

Why this rating - The materials strongly emphasize formation (virtue, wisdom) and a classical telos that transcends mere information transfer, aligning with CLASSICAL.

Cited evidence - Mission language and telos: turn0file1. - Exhortation language about classical tradition and formation: turn0file13. - Public framing of classical education at Highlands Latin: turn0file0.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The curriculum centers Latin and Greek as core components and articulates a grammar-logic-rhetoric (trivium) progression, with explicit descriptions of grammar school Latin memorization and subsequent study of syntax/translation using Henle texts (grades 3–12). This is central to Highland Latin's approach. - Latin begins early (as early as 2nd grade) and continues through high school, with classical languages forming the backbone of the curriculum. The program emphasizes mastery of Latin grammar and classical texts (Caesar, Ovid, Cicero) in later grades. - Greek is offered as part of the regular curriculum (grades 6–8) and optional in higher grades, described as a "crown jewel" of a classical Christian education. - The curriculum materials explicitly connect Latin/Greek study to broader aims in Western civilization and classical tradition, including the memorization of grammar, translations, and exposure to classical literature. - Additional curriculum elements referenced include classical studies, English/literature, music, and other

subjects under the broader “Academics” umbrella, all framed within the classical/traditional approach (e.g., Grammar School, Latin & Greek, Christian Studies, Classical Studies).

Positive keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Latin, Greek, grammar, logic, rhetoric, great books (via classical education framing), classics, Western civilization, sacred tradition, catechesis, reading the classics, memorization/recitation, and the trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric). Evidence examples include explicit language about Latin/Greek curricula and the grammar-logic-rhetoric framework.

- Negative keyword indicators: Not evident in the curriculum materials. The materials emphasize classical content rather than modern, project-based, or strictly STEM-first framing.

Why this rating - The curriculum is clearly anchored in the classical liberal-arts tradition with explicit focus on Latin/Greek, Great Books-era sensibilities, and a trivium-driven structure, meeting the CLASSICAL standard for Curriculum.

Cited evidence - Latin/Greek emphasis and Grammar School approach: turn0file4, turn0file3. - Early Latin and Greek as core to the curriculum; Henle texts; translation work: turn0file4. - Broad curriculum framed by classical/traditional terms: turn0file5 (course catalog/menu structure).

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school highlights a traditional classroom approach with quiet, orderly, and disciplined classrooms, with incremental, age-appropriate, skill-developing work. This is described as a hallmark of the traditional mode of instruction. - The grammar school explicitly emphasizes memorization of Latin grammar through oral recitation and form drills, demonstrating a strong emphasis on memory, repetition, and pedagogical forms typical of classical pedagogy. - The pedagogy integrates Latin/Greek study with a classical discipline, and there are mentions of recitations, memorization, and ritual/community practices (e.g., school exhortations with prayer and hymn). - The music program and choral activities illustrate an aesthetic dimension of pedagogy aligned with the classical tradition; the language of Western tradition and sacred music as learning tools is explicit.

Positive keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: classical education approach, memorization, recitation, memory, ritual/chant (implied through liturgy-like openings and choral components), rhetoric training, and the use of a living tradition in pedagogy (inferred from the “traditional” framing and emphasis on the trivium). Evidence includes explicit references to memorization/recitation in Latin grammar and the traditional classroom setting, plus the use of singing and choral activities as part of pedagogy.

- Negative keyword indicators: No explicit signals in the public materials that counter classical pedagogy (e.g., project-based only, student-directed discovery-only, or experiential-learning emphasis to the exclusion of memory/recitation). The sources emphasize memory work and recitation as well as Socratic-type discussions in some classical contexts, but explicit negative signals are not present in the provided materials.

Why this rating - The pedagogy is rooted in classic forms (recitation, memory, liturgical/community rhythm, and a structured progression through grammar/logic/rhetoric, along with a music program to form the whole person), consistent with CLASSICAL.

Cited evidence - Traditional classroom approach: turn0file6. - Latin grammar memorization and oral recitation: turn0file3. - Classical pedagogy framing and community/music as part of the pedagogy: turn0file13, turn0file18.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The public materials emphasize leadership by a founder (Cheryl Lowe) and a culture of master teachers and mentors who model virtue, skill, and knowledge, aligning with the living-curriculum concept. The founder is explicitly named, and the faculty is described in the context of a classical, traditional education model. - The mission emphasizes partnership with parents and a living curriculum shaped by the

faculty; there are references to “the portrait” of teachers and students, and to a collegial, student-centered teacher community (classical lexicon themes carried by the school’s messaging). - Materials describe the faculty as master teachers guiding students through classical pedagogy; the school’s public communications emphasize teacher-led instruction within a traditional/classical framework.

Positive keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: master teachers, mentors, living curriculum, portrait of a teacher, faculty as core, collegial culture, teacher as guide. The sources explicitly frame the faculty as the core (e.g., founder-led, tradition-based teaching). - Negative keyword indicators: None evident in the provided content. The public materials emphasize the teacher as a central figure and the living-curriculum concept rather than a detached, facilitators-on-the-sideline model.

Why this rating - The presence of founder-led classical pedagogy, the emphasis on teachers as exemplars and core to the curriculum, and the living-curriculum framing align with CLASSICAL.

Cited evidence - Founding leadership and Christian/classical framing: turn0file0, turn0file1. - Description of traditional/teacher-centered approach: turn0file6.

Element 6: School Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school explicitly frames partnership with families and parental formation as central to classical education: “In partnership with parents, and guided by the Gospel, we seek to educate students to the highest standards of the classical tradition” and similar language about parents as co-teachers and a community of learners. - The site advertises parent events, open houses, and opportunities for parents to participate and visit, including open houses on multiple campuses and community engagement through book studies and gatherings (as part of the broader classical-education ecosystem). - Public communications highlight parent involvement and the school’s willingness to host visits and actively engage families in the classical education process.

Positive keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with families, co-teachers, parental formation, open campus, family involvement, classical home culture, home-school alignment, parent formation, family catechesis. The materials frequently reference family involvement and parental partnership. - Negative keyword indicators: None evident in the public materials. The materials emphasize family partnership rather than consumer or passive-parent roles.

Why this rating - The family partnership model and explicit parent formation/gatherings indicate CLASSICAL alignment for Parents & Community.

Cited evidence - Partnership with families and Gospel-guided mission: turn0file1. - Open campus and parent engagement (open houses, visits): turn0file13, turn0file16.

What Would Move the Needle

- No major needle-moving changes are required. Highlands Latin School Louisville KY 40243 already demonstrates a coherent CLASSICAL orientation across all six categories, with explicit classical and Christian framing, classical curriculum (Latin/Greek; grammar-logic-rhetoric), traditional pedagogy (recitation, memory, disciplined classrooms), and strong faculty/parent/community integration.
- If one sought to push toward an even more manifest Classical Identity, potential areas (not deficiencies) could include:
 - Explicitly foregrounding “Great Books” and “Great Conversation” language in public pages to align with some classical lexicons more overtly (the public materials already imply this through “reading the classics,” but a distinct Great Books/Great Conversation phrasing would be a value-add).

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- Strengthening explicit Socratic/seminar terminology in upper grades to showcase a formal transition to dialogic instruction (the current materials emphasize traditional methods and rhetoric; a documented Socratic-seminar framework would strengthen Pedagogy).
 - Amplifying a formal “Living Books” program catalog or a defined “memory-work” progression mapped to grades to highlight the memory/recollection aspect of the Trivium more explicitly.

Note: These suggestions are enhancements, not corrections. The school already demonstrates CLASSICAL alignment in all key areas.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
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